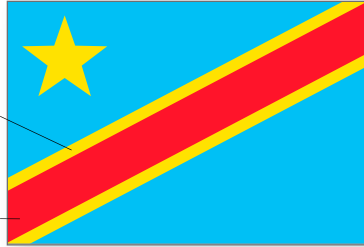


Dem. Rep. Congo

Ratio: 2:3 **Adopted:** February 18, 2006 **Usage:** National and Civil

*The gold fimbriations
suggest hope in
the future*

*The red diagonal
represents the blood
shed in civil wars.*



A blue flag with a yellow star was the flag of the Congo Free State from 1877–1908

Africa



The **Democratic Republic of Congo** was originally the Congo Free State (1880). In 1908 it became the Belgian Congo and gained independence in 1960.

The flag of the Dem. Rep. of Congo is like the design used 1964–1971. The flag of the Congo Free State was blue, with a central gold star. Under Belgian rule this flag remained, beside the Belgian flag. At independence in 1960, six stars were added down the hoist for the then six

provinces. In 1964 the design changed to one like the present flag.

In 1971, the name of the country changed to Zaïre, and the flag was based on that of the ruling party. In 1997 the 1960 flag was restored, but replaced by the present design in 2006.

FLAG OF CONGO
1960–1964 AND 1997–



FLAG OF ZAÏRE
1971–1997

